

 Challenge: Create a product or service that uses technology to foster genuine human connection and/or counter the growing loneliness in our digital society.

 Vision, mission & values

Vision: Less loneliness (Einsamkeit), everyone feels connected.

Mission: Create & strengthen weak ties in everyday moments, as easily as possible.

Values: Human-oriented; the digital platform is the means, not the end; minimal screen time; safety & privacy first; diversity.

 Revenue model & cost structure

Revenue:

- Free for users
- Restaurants pay per matched guest (fill off-peak seats, pay only for results)
- Promoted listings
- Later: SBB, Gemeinden, health insurers

Costs (low):

- Software development & hosting
- AI matching
- Verification service
- Marketing for one pilot district



Activities and services

Maps add-on: opt in when choosing a restaurant or train → AI matches on **shared interests** across **different ages & backgrounds** → same table + conversation starter → 1-tap "meet again?" → repetition turns weak ties into strong ones.



Target groups

Users: young people (16–30) who feel lonely: students, newcomers to a city, young professionals.
Also: older people living alone (mixing generations).
Paying customers: restaurants & cafés; later SBB.



Competitors

• **Timeleft** (dinners with strangers), Meetup, Bumble BFF, communal tables, Plauderbänkli
Our difference: no planning, everyday moments, **same people again**, deliberately mixed, inside the maps app you already use.



Strategic Partnerships

- Restaurants & cafés
- SBB ("chat compartment" on trains)
- Maps providers (Google Maps API, search.ch)
- Universities & student associations
- Gemeinden, Pro Senectute



Ressources

- Web app with Maps integration
- AI matching algorithm
- Verification & safety tools
- Small team: dev, partnerships, community
- Restaurant network



Impact
on people and society

Social:

- Less loneliness (a public-health issue)
- Weak ties build belonging
- Mixing ages & backgrounds reduces polarisation

Environmental:

- Uses existing spaces; fills off-peak seats, so less food waste
- Local meeting on foot or by public transport
- Measured by:** "would meet again" rate

Explanation of the Challenge Question

By "technology", we mean digital technology – such as apps, platforms, artificial intelligence or wearables. Your idea should either foster genuine human connection (e.g. between generations, in the neighbourhood or within communities) or help counter loneliness in our increasingly digital society – the "and/or" means that addressing one of the two is enough.